Chapter 1: Paragraph Structure

Writing Technique Questions, "Gold" (page 3)

1. Gold.
2. Gold is beautiful and useful.
3. In the first and last sentences.
4. Beautiful—Macedonian coin; useful—photography, dentistry, astronauts' suits.

Practice 1: Recognizing Topic Sentences (pages 6–8)

A. Group 2
   a. too general
   b. too specific
   c. inc. sent.
   d. best TS

   Group 3
   a. best TS
   b. too specific
   c. too specific
   d. inc. sent.
   e. too general

   Group 4
   a. inc. sent.
   b. too general
   c. too specific
   d. best TS

   Group 5
   a. too specific
   b. too general
   c. best TS
   d. too general
   e. inc. sent.

B. Paragraph 1: f
   Paragraph 2: c
   Paragraph 3: d
   Paragraph 4: b

Practice 2: Identifying the Parts of a Topic Sentence (page 9)

The topic is circled and the controlling idea is underlined.

2. (Driving on freeways) requires strong nerves.
3. (Driving on freeways) requires an aggressive attitude.
4. (The Caribbean island of Trinidad) attracts tourists because of its calypso music.
5. Spectacular beaches make (Puerto Rico) a tourist paradise.
6. (Moving away from home) can be a stressful experience for young people.
7. (Many religious rules) arose from the health needs of ancient times.
8. (A major problem for many students) is the high cost of tuition and books.

9. Participating in class discussions is (a problem for several different groups of students).
10. In my opinion, (television commercials for cosmetics) lie to women.
11. (Owning an automobile) is a necessity for me.
12. It is an expensive luxury (to own an automobile in a large city).
13. Taste and appearance are both important in (Japanese cuisine).

Practice 3: Writing Topic Sentences (pages 10–11)

A. Answers will vary. Examples:

Paragraph 1: English contains many foreign words. OR Words of foreign origin have enriched English.

Paragraph 2: The European and North American university systems have several important differences. OR The North American university system is different from the European system.

Paragraph 3: House construction worldwide depends on the most available native materials. OR Every region of the world has its indigenous (native) materials for building houses.

B. and C. Individual responses.

Practice 4: Supporting Sentences (pages 11–12)

Step 2. Although some people think red-light running is a minor traffic violation that is no worse than jaywalking, it can, in fact, become a deadly crime. Topic: red-light running. Controlling idea: It can become a deadly crime.

Step 3. An example: sentence 5; a statistic: sentence 3; a quotation: sentence 7

Writing Technique Questions, "Language and Perception" (page 13)

1. Main idea: Our language influences our perception. Part of topic sentence that expresses the main idea: ". . . our perception of the world depends to a great extent on the language we speak."
2. Examples: Eskimo languages have as many as 32 words for snow; falling snow, snow on the ground, snow packed as hard as ice, slushy snow, wind-driven snow; Aztec language has one word for snow, cold, and ice.
3. A classic example; for instance

Writing Technique Questions, "Concluding Sentences" (page 15)

1. The first paragraph—"Greeting Cards"
2. The second paragraph—"A Hawaiian Legend"
3. In short; This story is a good example.

Practice 5: Writing Concluding Sentences (pages 15–16)

Answers will vary. Examples:

Paragraph 1

Topic sentence: You can be a good conversationalist by being a good listener.

Concluding sentence: In summary, meaningful communication means using both good facial expressions and body language as well as showing interest in the speaker's words.

Paragraph 2

Topic sentence: Modern communication technology is driving workers in the corporate world crazy.

Concluding sentence: Indeed, faster communication technology may be creating more problems than workers can handle.